Optima Academy Online
An Education Experience Company

PHILOSOPHY HONORS: ETHICS

Suggested 18 Week Sequence
Semester 2 · Weeks 19–36

Teacher's Module	Covers	Student Copy
Suggested 18 Week Sequence	Weeks 19–36 (Quarters 3–4) · every week, lesson, and graded item	Course Guide & Schedule

This is the teacher's planning copy of the second semester, week by week: what students read and study, and what's due. It carries the same content as the student-facing Course Guide & Schedule, in the same format, so nothing drifts between what a teacher plans against and what a student actually sees. A matching sequence for the first semester (Weeks 1–18) is posted separately.

How each week works. Every week centers on one lesson, paired with a Comprehension Check quiz on that week's material (5 pts, auto-graded) and one graded Assignment or Warm-Up applying that week's ideas. Full essay-depth Assignments are worth 100 pts; the shorter Warm-Ups are worth 20 pts. Each module opens with a short reflection survey and closes with one that revisits it; neither counts toward your grade. The last week of every module also carries a Module Capstone (100 pts), a deeper assessment drawing on the whole module. See the Course Syllabus for exactly how much each of these counts toward your grade.

MODULE 1 · Q3 · WEEKS 19-20

Virtue Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
19	3.01 · Flourishing and the Highest Good *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book I, Chapters 1–5*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: What Does a Flourishing Life Look Like? · 20 pts
20	3.02 · Human Nature and Telos: The Function Argument *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book I, Chapter 7*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Does the Function Argument Succeed? · 20 pts Q3 Module 1 Capstone: Is Flourishing Grounded in Human Nature? · 100 pts

MODULE 2 · Q3 · WEEKS 21-22

Virtue Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
21	3.03 · Practical Reason and Phronesis *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book VI, Chapters 4–7 and 12–13*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: A Portrait of Practical Wisdom · 20 pts
22	3.04 · Character, Habit, and Moral Formation *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book II, Chapters 1–4*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Are We Responsible for Our Characters? · 20 pts Q3 Module 2 Capstone: Practical Wisdom and Responsibility for Character · 100 pts

MODULE 3 · Q3 · WEEKS 23-27

Virtue Ethics

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
23	3.05 · The Golden Mean: Virtue Between Extremes *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book II, Chapters 5–9*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Virtue as Excellence Between Extremes · 20 pts
24	3.06 · The Cardinal Virtues *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book III, Chapters 6–12 and Book V, Chapters 1–5*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: A Cardinal Virtue in Contemporary Life · 100 pts
25	3.07 · Friendship and the Good Life *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book VIII, Chapters 1–6 and Book IX, Chapters 4–9*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Warm-Up: Is Virtue-Friendship Necessary for Flourishing? · 20 pts
26	3.08 · Weakness of Will *Primary source: Aristotle, Nicomachean Ethics, Book VII, Chapters 1–3 and 8–10*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Socrates or Aristotle on Moral Failure? · 100 pts
27	3.09 · Quarter 3 Synthesis	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Eudaimonia and Virtue: Aristotle's Central Claim · 100 pts Q3 Module 3 Capstone: How Virtue Is Lived, Sustained, and Lost · 100 pts *Quarter 3 ends this week.*

MODULE 1 · Q4 · WEEKS 28-29

Foundations of Natural Law

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
28	4.01 · Nature and Moral Order *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica I-II, Questions 90–91*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Natural Law and Human Law: Drawing the Distinction · 100 pts
29	4.02 · The First Principle: Do Good *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica I-II, Question 94, Articles 1–2*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Responding to the Objection About Desire · 100 pts Q4 Module 1 Capstone: Can Natural Law Judge Human Law? · 100 pts

MODULE 2 · Q4 · WEEKS 30-31

The Content of Natural Law

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
30	4.03 · The Basic Human Goods *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica I-II, Question 94, Article 2; Finnis, Natural Law and Natural Rights (Ch. IV)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Are the Basic Goods Incommensurable? · 100 pts
31	4.04 · Moral Obligation *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica I-II, Question 94, Articles 4–6; Finnis, Natural Law and Natural Rights (Ch. V)*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: The Case Against Absolute Prohibitions · 100 pts Q4 Module 2 Capstone: Basic Goods and Absolute Prohibitions · 100 pts

MODULE 3 · Q4 · WEEKS 32-34

Natural Law and Its Rivals

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
32	4.05 · What Is Morality? *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica II-II, Question 64, Article 7*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Applying the Doctrine of Double Effect to Hiroshima · 100 pts
33	4.06 · Morality and God *Primary source: Plato, Euthyphro 9d–11b; Aquinas, Summa Theologica I-II, Question 93, Article 1*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Does Aquinas Escape the Euthyphro Dilemma? · 100 pts
34	4.07 · How Morality Is Known *Primary source: Aquinas, Summa Theologica I, Question 79, Articles 12–13 and I-II, Question 19, Articles 5–6*	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Aquinas on Conscience vs. the Mere Feelings Account · 100 pts Q4 Module 3 Capstone: Which Test Does Natural Law Handle Least Well? · 100 pts

MODULE 4 · Q4 · WEEKS 35-36

Synthesis and Capstone

Week	Lesson	Week's Work
35	4.08 · Quarter 4 Synthesis	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: Natural Law Theory: Contribution and Unresolved Objection · 100 pts
36	4.09 · Course Capstone	Comprehension Check · 5 pts Assignment: The Most Adequate Account of Morality · 100 pts Q4 Module 4 Capstone: One Case, Four Frameworks · 100 pts *Quarter 4 ends. Semester 2 and the course end this week.*

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